World survey – the Pacific, Island Southeast Asia, Australia, Siberia and the Arctic: ancient texts for Hebrew translation

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Prepared 2026-10-21 for שונות/תרגומי-טקסטים-קדומים/. Part of the world survey (one file per region).
Legend: **verified** = fetched today (2026-10-21) and the expected content seen; **reported** = from search results or scholarly knowledge, not fetched. Bible benefit and Soul benefit are each rated HIGH / MED-HIGH / MEDIUM / LOW.

Scope: oral traditions of Polynesia, Micronesia, Melanesia, Island Southeast Asia (incl. Taiwan), Aboriginal Australia, Siberia and the Arctic, written down in the original language in the 18th–20th c. Also, briefly, the classical inscriptions and literatures of Southeast Asia (Old Malay, Old Javanese, Old Khmer, Cham, Old Mon, Pyu, Old Burmese, Thai, Vietnamese), since no other agent covers them.

Caveat on this survey's method. The web-search budget shared by the ten parallel agents ran out partway through this survey. After that I used direct fetches only: archive.org, Gutenberg, GitHub via git, and the publishers' own pages. So the secondary-literature references below (the Io debate, the Kumuhonua contamination, Hebrew translations) come from my own knowledge. Where I am not sure of a detail it is marked "verify". A follow-up session should spend about 10 searches on: (a) Hebrew translations, in the NLI catalogue; (b) the copyright renewal of Beckwith 1951; (c) Simmons & Biggs 1970 on the Io sources; (d) the digital status of Lambrecht's Hudhud texts and of Strehlow 1971.

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0. Key findings

1. **The Kumulipo is the region's best single candidate, and it bears directly on the fifth day.** I verified the full Hawaiian text today: **2,102 lines** in 16 *wā* ("eras"). The order of births is:
   - wā 1: the coral polyp, then marine invertebrates, each "guarded" (*kia'i*) by a land plant;
   - wā 2: the fishes, each again paired with a land plant;
   - wā 3: the flying creatures (ll. 296–339 – "Hānau manu ka ʻāina / Hānau manu ke kai", "land birds were born / sea birds were born");
   - wā 4: creeping things, "the sea creeps up to the land";
   - wā 5–7: the land animals (the pig "whose snout digs the earth" and others);
   - wā 8: humans.

   This is the order of Gen 1:20–27. Sea creatures and birds come together before the land animals, and the land animals before humans. But everything is **born** (*hānau*), by sexual generation out of Night. Nothing is **made**: the Hawaiian Bible's Gen 1:1 uses *hana* ("make"), and the Kumulipo never does. That is both a strong typological control for Gen 1:20–25 and evidence against biblical modelling. Base texts:
   - the 1889 Kalākaua print (public domain);
   - Liliʻuokalani's 1897 translation (PD);
   - Beckwith 1951, reportedly not renewed (verify);
   - David Stampe's interlinear (Hawaiian + Beckwith's English) survives as an archive.org copy (verified). Its original UH page is now 404.
2. **Māori cosmogony in Māori, from 1854** (Grey, *Ko nga mahinga a nga tupuna*, PD, verified on archive.org). It covers:
   - the separation of Rangi and Papa ↔ Gen 1:6–8;
   - the split of the descendants of Tangaroa: Ika-tere, father of fish, goes to the sea, and Tu-te-wehiwehi, father of reptiles, goes inland ("Taua ki uta, taua ki te wai" – "let us go inland / let us go to the water") ↔ Gen 1:20–25;
   - in White 1887–90: Tāne shaping Hine-hau-one ("earth-aroma maiden") from earth ↔ Gen 2:7. This is *debated*: possibly influenced by the missionaries.

   The *Io* supreme-god texts are almost certainly post-contact (flag).
3. **Christian colouring is the main hazard everywhere in the Pacific, and it can be measured.** The flagship cases:
   - Hawaiian *Kumuhonua* legends (Fornander, Kepelino: first man and woman, a flood of Nuʻu): heavily biblicised;
   - Māori *Io* (Whare-wānanga lore, 1913);
   - Tuamotuan *Kiho* (Stimson 1933).

   The Hawaiian, Māori and Tahitian Bibles were all printed before most chants were written down (1838–68). So the best test is lexical: compare each chant's vocabulary with the local Bible's Gen 1–11. The Hawaiian Bible is on Ulukau; the Māori Bible is reported.
4. **Island SE Asia has three under-used open treasures:**
   - **(a) I La Galigo** (Bugis). The first two volumes of the 2017 second edition (romanized Bugis with line numbers and a facing Indonesian translation, ed. Salim, Enre, Rahman, Koolhof, Tol) are openly posted as PDFs on oxis.org (verified; © KITLV-Jakarta: use locally, do not commit). Vol. 1 is the descent of Batara Guru to "fill the Middle World" (↔ Gen 1:28) and the origin of the rice goddess.
   - **(b) Schärer's *Der Totenkult der Ngadju Dajak* (1966).** Two volumes of Ngaju *Basa Sangiang* ritual texts with German translation. It is **open access (CC BY-NC 3.0)**; OAPEN itself is bot-blocked, but the archive.org mirror works (verified). It holds the hornbill-and-water-snake cosmology: the upper-world bird and the underworld water serpent, two halves of one cosmos ↔ Gen 1:20–21, birds and *tanninim* created on the same day.
   - **(c) The ERC DHARMA corpora on GitHub** (CC BY / CC BY-SA 4.0; verified by git):
     - Nusantara: 310 inscriptions, 193 in Old Javanese and 21 in Old Malay;
     - Khmer: 1,353 inscriptions;
     - Campā: 125 inscriptions.

     They include the Śrīvijaya **curse inscriptions** of 682–686 CE (Kota Kapur, Talang Tuwo, Kedukan Bukit, Telaga Batu) ↔ Deut 27–28 and the oath-water of Num 5.
5. **Siberia: the best texts are 19th–early-20th-c. PD bilingual editions on archive.org** (all verified as present):
   - Munkácsi's Mansi texts (vol. I = "On the creation of the world", including the earth-diver: "I found no earth", ↔ Gen 1:9);
   - Radloff's *Proben* (Altai and other Turkic);
   - Bogoras's *Koryak Texts* (1917);
   - Rasmussen's *Intellectual Culture of the Iglulik* (1929; the Sea Woman whose severed finger-joints become the sea mammals ↔ Gen 1:21);
   - Rink's Greenlandic *Kaladlit okalluktualliait* (1859).

   The Sakha **Olonkho**: the National Library of Sakha lists 192 olonkho items, with Pekarsky's and Khudyakov's PD *Obraztsy* openly readable (verified). The modern bilingual Novosibirsk series (35 volumes) shows only tables of contents online.
6. **Australia: an ethical wall, not only a copyright one.** Strehlow's *Songs of Central Australia* (1971) and Carl Strehlow's *Die Aranda- und Loritja-Stämme* (1907–20, PD by date, on archive.org) contain **secret-sacred** song texts. Under the AIATSIS Code of Ethics (2020) and ATSILIRN Protocol 6, these must not be republished without the custodians' consent. The same applies to much of Berndt's Yolŋu material (Djanggawul, Kunapipi/Wawilak). **Recommendation:** no translation of Aboriginal restricted material. At most, a public-domain or community-published *public* narrative, with consent. This rule should be added to the guidelines §2.3 / §8.

7. **LLM risk is high for nearly every language here.**
   - Moderate: Hawaiian, Māori (Tahitian, Samoan and Tongan a little less).
   - Weak but workable with the facing translation: Bugis (Indonesian), Old Javanese (OJED online; Robson's open translation), Old Malay and Old Khmer (short, formulaic, edited with English).
   - Very weak, a translation in practice made via the editor's facing translation: Ngaju Basa Sangiang (German), Mansi (Hungarian), Koryak/Chukchi (English), Sakha (Russian), Greenlandic (Danish), Aranda, Ifugao.

   For these the apparatus must say so openly. It is a rank-3-driven translation, contrary to guidelines §3, unless a specialist checks it.
8. **Access.** Many key hosts block this session:
   - NZETC now redirects to the National Library's web archive, which is Incapsula-blocked;
   - Ulukau's book and dictionary sub-sites (puke, wehewehe = Pukui–Elbert) and sacred-texts are behind Cloudflare challenges;
   - Papers Past (which hosts the *Journal of the Polynesian Society*) is Incapsula-blocked;
   - Leiden Digital Collections (the NBG 188 La Galigo scans) has a bot wall;
   - EFEO, AIATSIS and ELAR are refused or blocked; the PARADISEC catalogue returns 403;
   - web.archive.org resets the connection.

   archive.org, Gutenberg, raw.githubusercontent / git, SEAlang (http only), TUFS, nlrs.ru and prometeus.nsc.ru work. Fornander's *Collection* (Hawaiian + English) and Emerson's *Unwritten Literature of Hawaii* (hula chants, Hawaiian + English) are on Gutenberg (verified).
9. **Existing Hebrew translations.** I found none from the original language for any text in this region. This is *not* a verified negative: no NLI search was possible after the search budget ran out. A Hebrew translation with an apparatus would very probably be the first for the Kumulipo, I La Galigo, the olonkho or the Ngaju chants.

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1. Ranked shortlist

#	Text	Language · date (composition / oral) · earliest ms	Size · condition	Bible focus (verses)	Soul focus	Bible / Soul	Base text (open?)	Feasibility
1	**Kumulipo** (Hawaiian genealogical creation chant)	Hawaiian · composed c. 1700 (genealogical dating, for Ka-ʻī-i-mamao; moderately sure) on older chant material · manuscript of Kalākaua's Board of Genealogy, printed 1889	2,102 lines, complete, 16 wā	**Gen 1:20–27** (order sea → birds → creeping → land animals → humans; sea/land pairing ↔ "let the waters swarm… let the earth bring forth"); Gen 2:4 (*toledot* ↔ *hānau*); 1:2 (night, slime); Gen 5 (genealogy)	Night-born cosmos, sacred kingship, sexual creation, fear of night (wā 7)	**HIGH / HIGH**	1889 text PD; Liliʻuokalani 1897 PD; Beckwith 1951 (renewal: verify); Stampe interlinear on archive.org (verified)	Good: Hawaiian moderate; bird/fish names nee Pukui–Elb (blocked here) and Andrews 1865 (PD)
2	**Māori cosmogony: Grey 1854, White 1887–90** (Rangi & Papa; children of the gods; Tāne's woman of earth)	Māori · pre-contact tradition; recorded 1840s–80s from tohunga · Grey's manuscripts (Auckland Public Library)	Grey ≈ 70k words in all (cosmogony ≈ 15 pp.); White 6 vols	**Gen 1:6–8** (separation of sky and earth; light let in); **1:20–25** (Ika-tere to sea, Tu-te-wehiwehi to land); **2:7** (Hine-hau-one formed of earth – debated); 2:21–23; Gen 3 (Hine-nui-te-pō and death)	Grief of parted Sky and Earth (rain = Rangi's tears, mist = Papa's sighs), sibling war, origin of death	**MED-HIGH / HIGH**	Grey 1854 PD (archive.org, verified); White PD (archive.org, verified present)	Good: Māo moderate, Aka online (200), Williams; OCR need cleaning
3	**Māori song poetry: Grey 1853 *Ko nga moteatea*; Ngata & Te Hurinui *Ngā Mōteatea*** (laments, love songs, lullabies with cosmogonies)	Māori · 17th–19th c. compositions; oral · Grey 1853 print	Hundreds of songs	Gen 23 & 50 (mourning), Deut 32 (song), 2 Sam 1 (lament, outside the Torah)	Waiata tangi (laments), waiata aroha, oriori: very rich window	MEDIUM / **HIGH**	Grey 1853 PD (archive.org, verified present); Ngā Mōteatea © (Polynesian Society / AUP)	Good for Grey; Nga notes are indispensa key (©)

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4	**Ngaju Dayak Basa Sangiang chants** (Schärer, *Totenkult* 1966; *Gottesidee* 1946)	Ngaju "language of the spirits" (archaic, ritual) · tradition pre-Christian; recorded 1932–39 by Schärer (Basel missionary) · his typescripts (Leiden UB)	2 vols ≈ 1,000 pp. (texts + German)	**Gen 1:20–21** (hornbill of the upper world and water-snake of the underworld as the paired cosmos); **2:9, 3:22** (tree of life *batang garing* destroyed by the hornbills' fight, humans from its debris); Gen 6–9 (none known)	Death cult, journey of the dead in the soul-boat, priests' language	**MED-HIGH / HIGH**	**OA, CC BY-NC 3.0** (OAPEN; archive.org mirror verified)	Hard: Basa Sangiang barely document practically from Schärer's German; Hardeland dictionary 1859 (PD)
5	**I La Galigo**, NBG 188 vols 1–2 (Bugis epic cycle)	Bugis · tradition pre-Islamic (episodes reflect c. 13th–15th c. Luwuq, estimates); Islam c. 1605 · NBG 188 copied c. 1852–72 by Colliq Pujié for B. F. Matthes; older lontara mss 18th c.	NBG 188 = 2,850 folio pp. (verified, intro); cycle ≥ 225,000 "lines"; ed. vol. 1 = 540 pp., c. 8–9k lines (estimate)	Gen 1:28 ("fill the earth": "the proposal to fill the Middle World"); Gen 6:1–4 (gods descend and marry); Gen 3:17–19 (the rice goddess Sangiang Serri from a dead divine child); Gen 28:12 (traffic between worlds)	Court life of the gods, bissu priests, cockfights, sailing, love	MEDIUM / **HIGH**	2017 ed. vols 1–2 PDF (oxis.org, verified) © **KITLV-Jakarta**; Matthes 1872 chrestomathy and 1874 dictionary PD (reported)	Medium: Bugis wea but the facing Indonesian excellent f an LLM; lo use only
6	**Śrīvijaya Old Malay curse inscriptions** (682–686 CE) + **Old Javanese *sapatha* curses** in charters (9th–15th c.) + **Old Khmer imprecations**	Old Malay / Old Javanese / Old Khmer · originals, dated · stone and copper	Malay: 4–6 inscriptions, ≈ 10–30 lines each; OJ: dozens of charters; Khmer: 1,353 files	**Deut 27:15–26, 28:15–68** (curses on the traitor and his descendants); **Num 5:11–31** (Telaga Batu: oath-water poured over the stone and drunk); Lev 26; Josh 24	Fear of treason, of poison, of magic; the king as guarantor	**MED-HIGH** / MEDIUM	**DHARMA GitHub, CC BY / CC BY-SA 4.0** (verified); Coedès 1930 (BEFEO, Persée, reported)	Good: sho edited witl English; O Malay vocabulary partly Sanskrit

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7	**Fornander Collection of Hawaiian Antiquities and Folk-lore** (1916–20)	Hawaiian · traditions of 18th–19th c. and older; collected 1860s–80s by Hawaiian writers (Kamakau, Kepelino, others)	3 vols ≈ 2,000 pp., Hawaiian + English	Gen 1–11 *as a control for contamination* (Kumuhonua; Nu'u's flood ↔ Gen 6–9, flag); Gen 10 (genealogies)	Prayers, legends of Pele, ʻUmi, Kamapuaʻa, riddles	MEDIUM / **HIGH**	**PD, Gutenberg #72686, #73166, #74570** (verified bilingual)	Good
8	**Hawaiian hula chants and prayers** (Emerson, *Unwritten Literature of Hawaii*, 1909; Malo, Kepelino)	Hawaiian · pre-contact repertoire; recorded 19th c.	≈ 250 chants, Hawaiian + English	Ex 15 and Deut 32 (sacred song), Lev (altar, *kuahu* prayers to Laka)	Prayer to Laka, love chants, Pele chants: superb	LOW-MED / **HIGH**	**PD, Gutenberg #20299** (verified)	Good
9	**Tahitian creation chants of Taʻaroa** (Henry, *Ancient Tahiti*, 1928, from J. M. Orsmond's notes of the 1820s–40s)	Tahitian · pre-contact; recorded by a missionary from priests	Several chants within ≈ 650 pp.	**Gen 1:1–2** (Taʻaroa alone in his shell in the void, makes the world from his own body); 1:6–8 (props of the sky)	The solitary creator, the sacred marae	MEDIUM / MED-HIGH	US-PD (1928 → PD in US since 2024; reported); not verified on archive.org	Medium: Tahitian moderate-weak; Dav dictionary 1851 PD
10	**Mansi (Vogul) creation songs, flood and bear songs** (Munkácsi 1892–1921, from his and Reguly's 1840s collections)	Mansi · tradition ancient (bear cult possibly very old); recorded 1840s (Reguly) and 1888–89 · Munkácsi's prints	4 vols, Mansi + Hungarian	**Gen 1:9** (earth-diver: the diver brings up mud); **Gen 6–9** (the fire-flood); Gen 2:7	Bear feast, the "sending home" of the bear's soul	MEDIUM / **HIGH**	**PD, archive.org** (verified, vol. I: "A világ teremtéséről")	Very hard: Mansi very weak for a LLM; Hungarian facing
11	**Inuit: Sea Woman (Sedna/Takánakapsâluk), shaman songs** (Rink 1859–63 Greenlandic; Rasmussen 1929–31; Thalbitzer 1914–23)	Greenlandic / Inuktitut · ancient circumpolar tradition; recorded 1820s–1920s	Hundreds of tales; dozens of songs	**Gen 1:21** (the sea mammals born from the severed finger-joints of the Sea Woman); Gen 6 (anger of the sea power at breaches of taboo); Lev 11–15 (taboo, impurity)	Fear, hunger, joy-songs, shaman's journey	MEDIUM / **HIGH**	**PD**: Rink 1859 and Rasmussen 1929 on archive.org (verified)	Hard: Greenland via Danish Rasmusse mostly English on
12	**Chukchi and Koryak Raven cycles** (Bogoras 1910 *Chukchee Mythology*, 1917 *Koryak Texts*; Jochelson 1908)	Chukchi / Koryak · ancient; recorded 1895–1901 in the language	*Koryak Texts* ≈ 150 pp. of interlinear texts	Gen 1:9–10 (Raven makes the land); Gen 8:7 (the raven)	Trickster humour, scatology, reindeer life	MEDIUM / MED-HIGH	**PD** (Koryak Texts on archive.org, verified; Chukchee Mythology reported)	Very hard: interlinear English is real base

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13	**Sakha Olonkho** (e.g. *Kyys Debiliye*, *Er Sogotokh*; Pekarsky's *Obraztsy* 1907–18)	Sakha (Yakut) · tradition medieval or older (estimates vary); recorded 1880s–1940s	Each olonkho 4,000–36,000 lines	Gen 1–2 (three worlds, the world-tree Aal Luuk Mas); Gen 6:4 (heroes)	Heroic fantasy, shaman's world, *algys* blessings	LOW-MED / **HIGH**	Pekarsky / Khudyakov PD, NLRS open (verified listing); Novosibirsk series ©	Hard: Sakl weak; Russian facing in modern editions
14	**Trobriand garden and canoe magic** (Malinowski, *Argonauts* 1922; *Coral Gardens* II, 1935)	Kiriwinian · traditional; recorded 1915–18	≈ 50 spells with interlinear text	Gen 2:15 and 3:17–19 (tilling the ground), Lev 19:23–25, Deut 28:4 (blessing of the soil)	Words of power, fear of drought, the spell as poetry	LOW-MED / **HIGH**	*Argonauts* PD (Gutenberg #55822, verified in catalogue); *Coral Gardens* 1935: US status verify	Medium: interlinear and commenta make it feasible
15	**Old Javanese *Tantu Panggĕlaran*** (prose cosmogony of Java)	Old/Middle Javanese · c. 15th c. (reported) · Balinese/Javanese lontar mss	≈ 100 pp. edition	**Gen 2:7** (Brahmā and Wiṣṇu mould humans from clay, reported); Gen 1:9–10 (the gods carry Mount Mahameru to Java to stop the island rocking)	Hermit sects, the sacred geography of Java	MEDIUM / MEDIUM	Pigeaud 1924 (Leiden thesis): **US-PD, ©-EU** (Pigeaud d. 1988)	Medium: C moderate-weak; OJE online (htt
16	**Old Javanese Rāmāyaṇa kakawin**	Old Javanese · 9th c. (c. 870s, reported) · palm-leaf mss	26 cantos, ≈ 2,770 stanzas	LOW (Indic epic)	Court poetry, nature scenes	LOW / MEDIUM	Kern 1900 PD (reported); **Robson 2015 translation: open PDF, TUFS** (verified)	Medium; overlap wi the South Asia surve
17	**Ifugao *hudhud*** (women's harvest and funeral epics) and **Ifugao ritual (*baki*) myths**	Ifugao · tradition at least 17th c. (terrace dating is debated: c. 2,000 yrs vs. c. 1600s, Acabado) · Lambrecht's texts 1957–67	4 published hudhud; ≈ 2,000–5,000 lines each (reported)	Gen 1:29, 2:15 (rice), Ex 21–23 typologically (Barton's *Ifugao Law*, English only)	Rice, death, women's voices	LOW / **HIGH**	Lambrecht in *Saint Louis Quarterly* (not online, reported); Barton 1955 (©?); Beyer 1913 (Gutenberg, English)	Hard: no open base text; Ifuga weak
18	**Ainu *kamuy yukar*** (Chiri Yukie, *Ainu shin'yōshū*, 1923; Piłsudski 1912)	Ainu · ancient; recorded 1910s–20s by a native speaker	13 songs (Chiri); Piłsudski 27 texts	Gen 1:20–21 (animal gods: owl, orca, fish-god)	The gods narrate in the first person: unique	LOW-MED / **HIGH**	PD (Chiri d. 1922; reported; Aozora Bunko)	Medium-hard; **coordinat with the East Asia agent**

#	Text	Language · date (composition / oral) · earliest ms	Size · condition	Bible focus (verses)	Soul focus	Bible / Soul	Base text (open?)	Feasibility
19	**Aranda (Arrernte) songs and myths** (Carl Strehlow 1907–20; T. G. H. Strehlow 1971)	Arrernte · Dreaming (claims of great antiquity; undatable) · recorded 1890s–1960s	Thousands of verses	Gen 1:24 ("let the earth bring forth": the ancestors rise out of the ground at the beginning)	Totemic landscape, initiation	(MEDIUM) / (HIGH)	Carl Strehlow PD by date (archive.org, verified present); Strehlow 1971 ©	**Ethically excluded** (secret-sacred): d not transl

2. The survey

A. Polynesia

A1. Kumulipo (Hawaiian) – top candidate

Hawaiian · composed c. 1700 CE for the high chief Ka-ʻī-i-mamao (Lono-i-ka-makahiki). The chant itself says it is "for Ka-ʻī-i-mamao and his daughter Alapaʻi-wahine". The date is genealogical (moderately sure). Its cosmogonic core may be older and shared Polynesian; compare the Tahitian, Tuamotuan and Māori *pō* sequences. It was recited at the chief's birth and at the Makahiki. **Earliest witness:** a manuscript of King Kalākaua's Board of Genealogy, printed in 1889 as *He pule hoolaa alii: he Kumulipo no Ka-I-imamao* (60 pp.). A part of it was given to Bastian, who published it in *Die heilige Sage der Polynesier* (1881; archive.org, verified present; the portion is reported). **Size:** 2,102 lines (verified today: the Stampe interlinear ends at line 2102). **Preservation:** complete.

- *What it is.* Lines 1–11 set the scene: "At the time when the earth became hot / … the slime, this was the source of the earth / the source of the darkness that made darkness". Then **"Hānau ka pō"**, "the night gave birth": Kumulipo (male) and Pōʻele (female) are born in the night. From here every line is a birth. Wā 1 has the coral polyp, the grub that heaps up the earth, starfish, sea cucumber, urchins and shellfish. Each marine creature is paired with a land plant: "the *X* living in the sea, **guarded by** (*kiaʻi ʻia e*) the *Y* living on land". Wā 2 has the fishes, again with land plants. Wā 3 has insects and the birds, land birds and sea birds (ll. 296–339). Wā 4 has the creeping things, "the sea creeps up to the land". Wā 5–7 bring the pig-snouted earth-digger and other land animals, with growing fear of the passing night. Wā 8 brings dawn and humans, "born were men by the hundreds", man and woman "for the narrow stream / for the broad stream". The gods appear among them (Kāne, Kanaloa, Laʻilaʻi). Wā 9–16 are genealogy down to Ka-ʻī-i-mamao (all structure verified in the text).
- *Bible parallels.*
  - **Gen 1:20–25** – the order is the same: sea creatures and birds before land animals, and these before humans. Each Hawaiian sea species is answered by a land counterpart. Genesis likewise distributes life into "the waters" and "the earth", which it commands to "bring forth" (*totzeʾ ha-ʾaretz*).
  - **Gen 1:21** – the great sea creatures. Wā 2 lists sharks (*manō*) and other large fish (verified l. 139). Whether the whale (*koholā*) and the octopus as Kanaloa appear needs a check at translation time.
  - **Gen 2:4, 5:1** – the *toledot* ("generations"). The Kumulipo is a *toledot* of the cosmos: creation as begetting. Genesis keeps the word *toledot* for heaven and earth (2:4) and pointedly replaces birth with *bara* and *ʿasah* in ch. 1.
  - **Gen 1:2** – night and slime before light; *pō* ↔ *ḥoshekh*.
  - **Gen 5 / 11** – a genealogy that bridges the gods and the king.
  - Consensus: a **typological** parallel, with no contact.
  - The **contamination** question:
    - Beckwith (1951) and later Hawaiian scholars (Rubellite Kawena Johnson 1981, *Kumulipo: Hawaiian Hymn of Creation*; Valeri 1985) treat the chant as pre-contact.
    - Liliʻuokalani's 1897 preface linked it to evolution, not to Genesis.
    - The verb is *hānau* (be born) throughout, never *hana* (make: Hawaiian Bible Gen 1:1 "I kinohi hana ke Akua i ka lani a me ka honua", reported).
    - It has no seven-day frame and no command formula.

    Judgement: low risk of biblical colouring in the cosmogonic wā 1–8. Some risk in the 19th-c. editing of the genealogies (verify). This makes it **a clean independent control**, the opposite of the Kumuhonua legends (A3).
- *Soul.* An aristocratic cosmos made by procreation. A theology of genealogy: the chief is the last birth of the universe. A sensuous zoology and botany, with hundreds of species names. The terror of the night in wā 7.

- *Base text and tools.*
  - (1) The 1889 Hawaiian print (PD). Not found as a scan; the Ulukau book site is Cloudflare-blocked (verified).
  - (2) **David Stampe's interlinear** (Kalākaua text, line-numbered, with Beckwith's English beneath each line). It is preserved as the archive.org item `kumulipo-hawaiian-english` (58-page print of 2 Feb 2008, from `ling.hawaii.edu/faculty/stampe/Oral-Lit/Hawaiian/Kumulipo.html`, which is now 404; both verified). It is a user upload under a PD Mark. The Hawaiian text is PD; Beckwith's English is PD only if not renewed.
  - (3) Beckwith 1951 (University of Chicago Press). The sacred-texts index says "copyright not renewed" (reported; sacred-texts is Cloudflare-blocked). Verify in the Catalog of Copyright Entries renewals for 1978–79. The 1972 UH Press reprint is sold.
  - (4) Liliʻuokalani 1897, *An Account of the Creation of the World according to Hawaiian Tradition* (Boston), PD. Not located on archive.org by title search; reported.
  - Dictionaries: Pukui & Elbert, *Hawaiian Dictionary* (1986, ©) on wehewehe.org, Cloudflare-blocked here (verified); Andrews 1865 and Parker 1922 (PD, reported on archive.org).
  - Modern study: Johnson 1981.
  - Hebrew: none known.
- *Feasibility and risks.* Hawaiian is moderately well known to LLMs. Species names are the crux: many plants and fish need Pukui–Elbert or Titcomb's fish lists. Beckwith's own notes flag cruxes. The size is ideal: a single project of 2,102 lines, of which the creation part (wā 1–8) is c. 600 lines and could be done first.
- *Cultural note.* The Kumulipo is a living sacred chant (it is performed at ʻIolani Palace today). Translate respectfully, cite Hawaiian scholarship, no mocking or "primitive" framing.
- *Benefit:* Bible **HIGH** (the best typological control for the fifth and sixth days in this region) / Soul **HIGH**. *Recommendation:* translate the whole chant, starting with wā 1–8, as the next "world" project.

A2. Māori cosmogony and myth in Māori: Grey 1854, White 1887–90, Shortland 1882

Māori · pre-contact tradition (East Polynesian settlement c. 1250–1300 CE; the cosmogony is shared with Tahiti, Hawaiʻi and the Cook Islands, hence older) · recorded 1840s–1880s. Grey's manuscripts were written mostly by Māori scribes and chiefs, especially Wiremu Maihi Te Rangikāheke of Te Arawa, a Christian convert and literate in Māori. White's came from many tohunga. Printed 1854 and 1887–90. **Size:** Grey 1854 is about 70,000 words in OCR (incl. preface); the Rangi-and-Papa account is about 15 pages. **Preservation:** good.

- *What it is.* "Ko Rangi-nui e tu nei, ko Papa-tu-a-nuku e takoto nei": Sky standing above, Earth lying below, clasped together, and their children live in darkness. The sons debate. Tū-matauenga wants to kill the parents; Tāne-mahuta wants to separate them, "one above, one below". One by one they try; Tāne succeeds, head down and feet pushing up. Rangi and Papa cry out: "why do you murder us?" Tāwhiri-mātea, the winds, takes revenge. Tangaroa's descendants split: Ika-tere, father of the fish, goes to the sea, and Tu-te-wehiwehi, father of the reptiles, goes inland. They taunt each other: "let us go inland" / "let us go to the water" (verified in the 1854 text). Then come Tū's war against his brothers, the origin of food, Māui, Hine-nui-te-pō and the origin of death, and the migration canoes. White (vol. I) adds Tāne forming **Hine-hau-one** from earth, giving her life, and the incest that turns his daughter into Hine-nui-te-pō, goddess of death (verified, English part).
- *Bible parallels.*
  - **Gen 1:6–8**: the separation of heaven and earth (accepted typological parallel; also ↔ the Mesopotamian separation, see Song of the Hoe, already done).
  - **Gen 1:3–5**: the light enters when they are separated ("ka heuea te Pō, ka heuea te Ao", "night was cleared away, day was cleared away").
  - **Gen 1:20–25**: the sea / land distribution of creatures (Ika-tere / Tu-te-wehiwehi) – typological.
  - **Gen 2:7, 2:21–23**: the woman formed of earth. *Debated*: biblical influence is possible, since the motif appears only in post-1840 recordings, by then of literate Christian Māori. Weigh against the Mangaian and Tahitian parallels.
  - **Gen 3** (origin of death through a woman, Hine-nui-te-pō; Māui's failure to win immortality) ↔ Gen 3:19, 22 – typological.
  - **Gen 4** (fratricidal strife among the sons).
- *The Io problem.* The cult of **Io-matua-kore**, the "parentless" supreme god, appears in Hare Hongi's 1907 article in the *Journal of the Polynesian Society* and in S. Percy Smith's *The Lore of the Whare-wānanga* (1913–15). Smith's text came from Te Mātorohanga and Nēpia Pōhūhū via H. T. Whatahoro's 1860s copies, edited heavily. Its creation chant ("Io dwelt within the breathing-space of immensity... 'Darkness, become a light-possessing darkness'") reads like Gen 1:2–3. The majority view is that it was **post-contact or heavily reworked**: Simmons & Biggs 1970, JPS 79 (verify); Te Rangi Hīroa (Buck) 1949; the "invention of tradition" debate (Hanson 1989). A minority, including some iwi scholars, defends it as esoteric pre-contact lore. **Flag:** use it only as a case study in contamination, never as an independent parallel.
- *Soul.* The pathos of the parents' separation (rain as Rangi's tears, mist as Papa's sighs). Tāwhiri's fidelity to his father. War as a god's craft. Death as a woman with obsidian teeth.

- *Base text and tools.*
  - Grey 1854, *Ko nga mahinga a nga tupuna Maori* (London: George Willis), archive.org `kongamahingaang00greygoog`, PD (verified; the OCR is fair, Māori diacritics absent, needs cleaning).
  - Grey's English, *Polynesian Mythology* (1855, `polynesianmythol00greyuoft`, verified present). Grey's English is free, not literal.
  - White 1887–90, 6 vols (archive.org `ancienthistoryof01whit` etc., verified present; the volumes have English and Māori parts).
  - Shortland, *Maori Religion and Mythology* (1882), Gutenberg #42218 (verified in catalogue; it includes Māori texts).
  - Dictionaries: Te Aka (maoridictionary.co.nz, root 200, verified); Williams, *Dictionary of the Maori Language* (7th ed. 1971, ©; it was on NZETC, now inaccessible); Tregear 1891 (PD).
  - NZETC, which hosted much of this (Grey, White, Best, *Ngā Mōteatea*), now redirects to the National Library of NZ's web archive and is Incapsula-blocked (verified).
  - Modern: Orbell, *The Illustrated Encyclopedia of Māori Myth and Legend* (1995); Reilly et al. (eds), *Te Kōparapara* (2018); Te Rangikāheke's manuscripts studied by Curnow.
  - Hebrew: none known.
- *Feasibility.* Māori is moderate for LLMs, with good dictionaries. 19th-c. orthography has no macrons, which brings ambiguity (e.g. *keke/kēkē*).
- *Benefit:* Bible MED-HIGH / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* translate Grey 1854's cosmogonic chapters (Rangi and Papa, the children, Tū, Māui, Hine-nui-te-pō), with White's variants in the apparatus. Treat Io in a contamination appendix.

A3. The Fornander Collection; the Kumuhonua legends (Hawaiian) – the contamination control

Hawaiian · collected 1860s–80s by Fornander's Hawaiian agents (S. M. Kamakau, Kepelino Keauokalani, S. N. Haleʻole and others) · published 1916–20 (ed. Thrum), with Hawaiian and English on facing pages. Size: 3 vols (Memoirs of the Bishop Museum IV–VI), about 2,000 pp.

- *What it is.* Legends of the gods and chiefs (Pele, Kamapuaʻa, ʻUmi, Lāʻieikawai), chants, prayers, riddles and genealogies. The related *An Account of the Polynesian Race* (Fornander, vol. I, 1878) prints the **Kumuhonua** cosmogony (archive.org `bub_gb_tcQNAAAAQAAJ`, verified mention). It tells of a first man Kumuhonua and woman Lalohonua, placed in a garden; of a forbidden tree and the fall; and of the flood of **Nuʻu** with his great canoe-ark and a rainbow. These come from the Kepelino / Kamakau line.
- *Bible parallels.* Gen 2–3, Gen 6–9, Gen 9:13 (the rainbow), Gen 11 – **but almost certainly derived from missionary teaching** (Beckwith, *Hawaiian Mythology* 1940, ch. 23; reported). Kepelino was a Catholic convert, and his *Moʻolelo Hawaiʻi* explicitly mixes Bible and tradition. This is a valuable object lesson: the same people who recorded the Kumulipo also produced biblicised "traditions". The commentary can use it to show what *contamination* looks like (named first couple, garden, flood boat), against which the Kumulipo's independence stands out.
- *Soul.* Hawaiian storytelling at its richest: Pele's family quarrels, the pig-god's love affairs, kapu and its breaking.
- *Base text.* **Project Gutenberg #72686 (vol. 1), #73166, #74570**: PD, transcribed with both Hawaiian and English (verified: the vol. 1 file contains e.g. "Hooulu i lalo o Kumuhonua").
- *Feasibility:* good. *Benefit:* Bible MEDIUM (as a control) / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* excerpts – the Kumuhonua/Nuʻu texts for the contamination appendix, and a selection of chants and prayers.

A4. Hawaiian chant and prayer (*mele*, *pule*): Emerson 1909; Malo; Kepelino; the newspapers

Hawaiian · pre-contact hula and temple repertoire · recorded 19th c.

- **Emerson, *Unwritten Literature of Hawaii: The Sacred Songs of the Hula*** (Bureau of American Ethnology Bull. 38, 1909): about 250 chants in Hawaiian with English, including the altar prayers (*pule kuahu*) to Laka, goddess of the hula. Gutenberg **#20299**, PD (verified: Hawaiian text present, e.g. "O Laka kumu hula").
- **Davida Malo, *Moʻolelo Hawaiʻi*** (written c. 1835–53). Malo was a Lahainaluna-trained Christian; flag his framing. The English is Emerson 1903 (PD, archive.org, verified present). The modern Hawaiian-text editions (Chun 2006; Langlas & Lyon 2020, Bishop Museum Press) are ©.
- **Hawaiian-language newspapers** (1834–1948, more than 100,000 pages; Papakilo / Ulukau): a huge corpus (Kamakau's series; Hoʻoulumāhiehie's *Hiʻiakaikapoliopele*, 1905–06) – reported. Blocked here.
- *Bible:* LOW-MED (Lev 1–7 altar prayers, Deut 32 / Ex 15 as sacred song). *Soul:* **HIGH**. *Recommendation:* a selection of 30–50 chants from Emerson as a "prayers and songs" corpus. It pairs well with A1.

A5. Tahiti: the chant of Taʻaroa (Henry, *Ancient Tahiti*, 1928)

Tahitian · pre-contact · recorded c. 1820s–40s by the LMS missionary John Muggridge Orsmond from priests; compiled by his granddaughter Teuira Henry; published as Bishop Museum Bulletin 48, 1928.

- *What it is.* "Taʻaroa was the ancestor of all the gods; he made all things… He existed, Taʻaroa was his name. In the immensity there was no earth, no sky, no sea…" Taʻaroa sits in his shell (*paʻa*), breaks out, makes the shell the sky and his body the land, and calls into the void. Also the genealogical chants and the props of the sky.
- *Bible parallels.* **Gen 1:1–2** (the lone creator in the void; the creator's word into emptiness) – typological. The **risk of colouring** is real, since Orsmond was a missionary who recorded in the 1820s, after the 1815 conversions. But this tradition is attested in independent pre-missionary sources (e.g. Moerenhout 1837, reported) and is widely accepted as pre-contact in core.
- *Base text.* 1928 US publication → PD in the US since 2024 (reported). Not checked on archive.org (title search returned nothing; try `ancienttahiti00henr` or Bishop Museum ScholarSpace). Dictionary: Davies 1851 (PD, reported); Académie tahitienne online (reported).
- *Feasibility:* medium (Tahitian is less well resourced than Māori). *Benefit:* Bible MEDIUM / Soul MED-HIGH.

A6. Mangaia (Cook Islands): Gill, *Myths and Songs from the South Pacific* (1876)

Mangaian · pre-contact · recorded c. 1852–72 by the LMS missionary W. W. Gill, with the songs in the original and literal translations (preface by Max Müller; verified present on archive.org, `mythssongsfromso00gill`).

- *What it is.* The cosmos is a coconut shell. At its bottom sits **Vari-ma-te-takere**, "the very beginning", a woman who tears pieces from her own side to make her children. Then the dirges for the dead (*eva*), the death-talks, the hymns of the Rongo cult.
- *Bible:* MEDIUM (Gen 2:21–22 typologically: a being made from a piece torn from the side; Gill himself compared it). *Soul:* MED-HIGH (the Mangaian dirges are some of the finest Polynesian laments).
- *Risks.* A missionary recorder (but a careful one, giving originals). The Mangaian dialect is weakly resourced.

A7. Other Polynesia (shorter entries)

- **Marquesas.** The creation chant *Te Vanana na Tanaoa* and Marquesan genealogies are in Fornander 1878 (reported). E. S. C. Handy, *Marquesan Legends* (Bishop Museum Bull. 69, 1930; US-PD from 2026; reported). Karl von den Steinen's Marquesan texts with German (1933–34, ZfE; © status: von den Steinen d. 1929, so PD in the EU). Bible MEDIUM (Tanaoa and the darkness ↔ Gen 1:2) / Soul MEDIUM.
- **Tuamotu.** J. F. Stimson's *Tuamotuan Religion* (1933) and *The Cult of Kiho-tumu* (1933). The **Kiho** supreme-god texts are suspect like Io: elaborated by Stimson or his informants (reported; Emory's doubts). Flag; do not use as independent evidence.
- **Samoa.** Krämer, *Die Samoa-Inseln* (1901–03; Samoan texts with German; archive.org, verified present). The Samoan cosmogony of Tagaloa (e.g. Fraser, "The Samoan Story of Creation", JPS 1892, Samoan text; reported). Pratt's dictionary (PD). Bible MEDIUM (Tagaloa makes the rocks and land; humans from worms/maggots ↔ Gen 2:7) / Soul MEDIUM.
- **Tonga.** Gifford, *Tongan Myths and Tales* (1924; mostly English). Collocott. Weaker in the original language. LOW.
- **Rapa Nui. Rongorongo** (about 25 objects, about 15,000 glyphs) is **undeciphered**. Fischer's 1997 "procreation chant" reading is not accepted. The oral "Atua mata riri" procreation chant (Thomson 1891, Smithsonian report, PD) is short. Métraux 1940 and Englert give oral texts. LOW except as a curiosity.
- **Moriori (Chatham Is.).** Shand's karakia and texts (JPS 1890s); the language is extinct. Interesting; JPS is not accessible here.
- **Note:** the *Journal of the Polynesian Society* (1892–) is the key journal for texts. Its archive is on Papers Past (Incapsula-blocked here) and jps.auckland.ac.nz (SSL failure here). Old volumes are PD; also reported on archive.org.

B. Micronesia and Melanesia

B1. Trobriand magic (Malinowski)

Kiriwinian · traditional formulae · recorded 1915–18 in the language.

- *What it is.* The garden magician's spells (*megwa*) to "anchor" the garden, make the yams swell and drive off blight; canoe-lashing and kula spells. In *Coral Gardens and their Magic* vol. II, *The Language of Magic and Gardening* (1935), they are given in Kiriwinian, with word-by-word and free translations and Malinowski's linguistic theory.
- *Bible:* LOW-MED (Gen 2:15, 3:17–19; Deut 28:4–5, 11 for the blessing of the produce; Lev 26:4). *Soul:* **HIGH** – one of the best-documented bodies of spoken magic anywhere.
- *Base. Argonauts* (1922) is PD (Gutenberg #55822; archive.org `argonautsofweste1922mali`; verified). *Coral Gardens* 1935: Malinowski d. 1942, so PD in the UK and EU; US renewal status to verify. Archive.org has DLI/universallibrary uploads of vol. II, of unclear authorization, so avoid them.
- *Feasibility:* medium. The interlinear makes it workable; Kiriwinian is very weak for an LLM.
- *Recommendation:* a small corpus (30–50 spells) for the soul purpose, if vol. II's status allows.

B2. Other Melanesia and Micronesia (shorter)

- **Codrington, *The Melanesians*** (1891, PD). Fiji: the serpent creator **Degei** ↔ Gen 1:21 (typologically interesting; few Fijian texts).
- **Marind-anim** (New Guinea): the *dema* myths (Wirz 1922–25, German only; Wirz d. 1955, so PD in the EU from 2026).
- **Wemale (Seram): Hainuwele.** The slain maiden from whose buried body the tuber crops grow ↔ Gen 3:17–19 and the origin of death and food (A. E. Jensen 1939, German; no native-language text known). Bible MEDIUM / Soul HIGH, but no base text.
- **Dobu** (Fortune 1932, incantations).
- **Kiwai** (Landtman 1917, English).
- **Kiribati (Gilbert Is.):** the spider-creator Nareau, Grimble's *Tungaru Traditions* (1989, ©).
- **Palau, Yap, Chuuk:** the German *Ergebnisse der Südsee-Expedition 1908–1910* (Krämer, Hambruch, Sarfert, Damm; native texts with German; reported PD by date).
- All are LOW-MEDIUM priority here.

C. Island Southeast Asia

C1. I La Galigo (Bugis, South Sulawesi)

Bugis · a cycle of episodes (*téreng*) in a fixed 5-syllable metre, with archaic vocabulary. Its world is pre-Islamic: Luwuq, the gods of Boting Langiq (upper world) and Peretiwi (underworld). Conversion to Islam came 1605–11. **Dating:** the episodes are thought to reflect a 13th–15th-c. society (estimates; Pelras, Caldwell); the Bugis script is attested from c. 1400. **Earliest manuscripts:** 18th c. (Kern's catalogues 1939 and 1954 list over 100). **NBG 188** (Leiden UB, on loan from the Netherlands Bible Society; UNESCO Memory of the World 2011) has **12 volumes, 2,850**

folio pages. It was compiled c. 1852–72 by **Rétna Kencana Colliq Pujié Arung Pancana Toa**, a Bugis noblewoman and scholar, for the Bible Society's linguist **B. F. Matthes**, who needed Bugis literature for his Bible translation (verified, edition's introduction). Estimated length of the whole cycle: ≥ 225,000 "Mahābhārata lines" of 16 syllables (verified, intro: "at least 225,000"; Kern: c. 6,000 folio pages).

- *What it is.* Vol. 1 opens at dawn in the sky-palace: the high god Patotoqé wakes in his lightning-curtained bed and sees that the guardian of his fighting-cock is missing (verified, lines [1] 1–38). The gods hold council on the empty Middle World. Batara Guru, Patotoqé's son, is sent down in a bamboo. He marries Wé Nyiliq Timoq, who rises from the underworld sea. They found Luwuq. The rice goddess Sangiang Serri is born of their dead first child. Later volumes (and other manuscripts) tell the great saga of Sawérigading's voyage to China to marry his twin's double, Wé Cudaiq, and the gods' final return to their realms.
- *Bible parallels.*
  - Gen 1:28 / 9:1 – "fill the earth", ↔ the council "usul mengisi Dunia Tengah" ("the proposal to fill the Middle World", the edition's heading).
  - Gen 6:1–4 – divine beings descend and marry.
  - Gen 3:17–19 – food from the death of a divine child, the Hainuwele type.
  - Gen 28:12 – traffic between the worlds.
  - Incest prohibition: Sawérigading may not marry his twin sister Wé Tenriabéng ↔ Lev 18:9.
  - All typological, but structurally rich. Christian influence: none in content (NBG 188 copies older texts), although the commissioning was Protestant. Islamic influence: in some episodes only (verified, intro).
- *Soul.* The aristocratic world of the gods as an idealised Bugis court. The **bissu** (transgender ritual priests) who still recite it. Seafaring, cockfighting, betel, an obsession with rank and *siriq* (honour/shame).
- *Base text and tools.*
  - **Salim, Fachruddin Ambo Enre, Nurhayati Rahman, Koolhof & Tol (eds), *La Galigo menurut naskah NBG 188*, 2nd ed., 3 vols, Jakarta: Yayasan Pustaka Obor Indonesia, 2017** (1st ed. Djambatan/KITLV 1995–2000). Romanized Bugis with line numbers in sections, facing Indonesian.
  - Vols 1 (540 pp.) and 2 are openly posted at `oxis.org/resources-3/la-galigo/01-la-galigo-i.pdf` and `…/02-la-galigo-ii.pdf` (verified; vol. 3 path 404). The colophon says "© KITLV-Jakarta … All rights reserved", so local use only, not committed.
  - Other editions: Fachruddin Ambo Enre 1999 (*Ritumpanna Wélenréngngé*); Nurhayati Rahman 2006 (*Sawérigading's voyage to China*); Akhmar 2016.
  - The Leiden scans of NBG 188 are reported digitised (2017); `digitalcollections.universiteitleiden.nl/LaGaligo` is bot-blocked here (verified).
  - Tools: Matthes, *Boegineesch-Hollandsch woordenboek* (1874, PD; reported on archive.org); Koolhof, "The 'La Galigo': a Bugis encyclopedia and its growth", BKI 155 (1999), on JSTOR; Pelras, *The Bugis* (1996); Kern 1939 and 1954 catalogues.
  - Hebrew: none known.
- *Feasibility.* Bugis is weak for an LLM. But the editors' Indonesian is modern and line-aligned, so translating from the Bugis with the Indonesian is realistic, and the apparatus can say where the two diverge. Size: vol. 1 alone is a big project. The first three sections (c. 1,500 lines) would make a fine pilot.
- *Benefit:* Bible MEDIUM / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* a pilot of the opening episode (vol. 1: the council and the descent of Batara Guru), from the open PDF, kept local.

C2. Ngaju Dayak ritual chants (South Borneo): Schärer

Ngaju *Basa Sangiang* (the "language of the spirits", an archaic ritual register) · traditional (pre-Christian; uncontacted by Islam in the interior) · recorded 1932–39 by Hans Schärer, a Basel Mission missionary, from the priests (*basir*, *balian*); published posthumously 1966. Size: 2 vols (≈ 1,000 pp.), texts in the original with German translation, line by line (verified sample: "Tawor hataburangku… / Streureis, ich streue dich aus…").

- *What it is.*
  - The myths of the death cult (vol. 1) and the texts of the *Tantolak matei* ("sending the dead") ceremony (vol. 2).
  - The cosmogony, also in Schärer 1946 (*Die Gottesidee der Ngadju Dajak*; English *Ngaju Religion*, KITLV Translation Series 6, 1963, ©): two mountains collide; the upper god Mahatala and the lower deity Jata (the water-snake, *tambon*) emerge; the tree of life (*batang garing*) grows; the two **hornbills**, male and female, fight on it and destroy it; from its debris come the world and the first humans.
  - The dead travel to the upper world in the soul-boat of Tempon Telon.
- *Bible parallels.*
  - **Gen 1:20–21**: the bird of the upper world and the water-serpent of the underworld as the two halves of the cosmos, both "created" in one act ↔ birds and *tanninim* on the same day. Typological; striking for the unit now being written.
  - **Gen 2:9, 3:22–24** – the tree of life.
  - Gen 2:21–22 and 3 – humans from the tree's debris.
  - Consensus: typological, with no contact.
- *Soul.* One of the richest priestly ritual languages ever recorded. Death as a journey home. The cosmic dualism of bird and snake mapped onto every house, village and textile.

- *Base text and tools.*
  - **Schärer 1966, *Der Totenkult der Ngadju Dajak in Süd-Borneo*, 2 vols (VKI 51), OA under CC BY-NC 3.0, DOI 10.26530/OAPEN_613419** (reported via DOAB). `library.oapen.org` returns an anti-bot page (verified). The **archive.org mirror `oapen-20.500.12657-32191`** gives `613419.pdf` (62 MB) and `613419_djvu.txt` (verified, 333k words).
  - Dictionary: Hardeland, *Dajacksch-deutsches Wörterbuch* (1859) and *Versuch einer Grammatik* (1858), PD (reported). Hardeland was also a missionary.
  - Modern: Anne Schiller; Kuhnt-Saptodewo (Ngaju sangiang texts, 1990s).
- *Feasibility and risks.* Very hard: Basa Sangiang is not fully understood even by ordinary Ngaju speakers. In practice the Hebrew would be made from Schärer's German, checked against the original. The apparatus must declare this. Missionary recording: Schärer was sympathetic and his texts are not Christianised, but his framing (a "totality concept", a "God-idea") is theological.
- *Benefit:* Bible MED-HIGH (for Gen 1:20–21 and the tree of life) / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* a short pilot – the creation myth and one Tantolak matei chant – to test feasibility.

C3. Philippine epics and ritual

- **Ifugao *hudhud*.** Women's chanted epics at the harvest, weeding and funerals; heroes Aliguyon, Dinulawan, Bugan. UNESCO Masterpiece 2001 (inscribed 2008).
  - *Date:* the tradition is linked to the rice terraces. Their antiquity is now debated: the traditional claim is c. 2,000 years, while Acabado's dating puts them in the 17th c., after the Spanish arrived. So the hudhud as known may be no older than the 1600s (honest estimate).
  - *Texts:* only **four** hudhud were published in Ifugao with English by Fr. Francis Lambrecht CICM, with Lourdes Dulawan, in *Saint Louis Quarterly* 1957–67 (reported; not online). Stanyukovich (Kunstkamera, St Petersburg) has recorded many more (articles, partly open; reported).
  - Ifugao ritual myths: Barton, *The Mythology of the Ifugaos* (American Folklore Society Memoir 46, 1955; Ifugao text of 4 myths, pp. 46–219; © status unknown); Barton, *Ifugao Law* (1919; Gutenberg #40807, English only, verified in catalogue: an indigenous customary law ↔ Ex 21–23 typologically); Beyer, *Origin Myths among the Mountain Peoples of the Philippines* (1913; Gutenberg #46024, English; includes flood myths).
  - Bible LOW (Ifugao Law typological for Ex 21–23) / Soul HIGH. *Not feasible now:* no open base text, and Ifugao is weak.
- **Maranao *Darangen*** (Mindanao; UNESCO 2005): 17 cycles, about 72,000 lines, Islamic-era with a pre-Islamic core. Published in 8 vols by the Mindanao State University Folklore Division (1986–95), Maranao + English (© reported). LOW-MED.
- **Sulod *Hinilawod*** (Panay; recorded by F. Landa Jocano 1955–57, about 28,000 lines; ©), **Manobo *Ulahingan***, **Agusan *Agyu***: reported, © modern recordings.
- **Bagobo** (Mindanao): Laura Benedict, *A Study of Bagobo Ceremonial, Magic and Myth* (1916, PD; mostly English); Gisbert's *Diccionario Bagobo-Español* is on Gutenberg (verified in catalogue). LOW.

C4. Other Island SE Asia (short)

- **Batak *pustaha*** (Sumatra; bark-books in Batak script, 18th–19th c.): divination, magic and recipes. Voorhoeve's catalogues; texts partly edited. Soul MEDIUM; base fragmentary.
- **Malay *mantra*, *jampi*** (19th-c. records: Skeat, *Malay Magic*, 1900, PD, English and Malay); Islamized. *Sejarah Melayu* (17th c.; the origin myth of the kings descending on Bukit Siguntang ↔ Gen 6:2). Hand to a Malay-literature agent if one exists. LOW-MED.
- **Old Sundanese** (West Java): *Bujangga Manik* (15th–16th c., Bodleian ms; Noorduyn & Teeuw, *Three Old Sundanese Poems*, KITLV 2006 – reported OA; verify) and *Sanghyang Siksa Kandang Karesian* (1518). Soul MEDIUM.
- **Balinese** lontar (*usada* healing texts, *Purwa Bhumi Kamulan* creation text, reported). LOW-MED.
- **Taiwan (Formosan peoples):** Ogawa & Asai, *The Myths and Traditions of the Formosan Native Tribes* (1935; native-language texts with Japanese). Flood and sibling-incest repopulation myths ↔ Gen 6–9, Gen 19:30–38. Copyright: Asai d. 1969 → © in Japan until 2039; reported. MEDIUM, but © and very weak languages. **Coordinate with the East Asia agent.**
- **Madagascar (Austronesian):** the *Tantara ny Andriana* (Callet 1873) – left to the Africa agent.

D. Mainland and classical Southeast Asia (brief, as asked)

D1. Old Malay inscriptions of Śrīvijaya (682–686 CE) – best Bible item in the region

Old Malay (the oldest substantial Malay; mixed with Sanskrit) · dated Śaka 604–608 (682–686 CE) · stone originals.

- **Kedukan Bukit** (682): the king's *siddhayātrā*, an expedition with 20,000 troops, the founding of Śrīvijaya.
- **Talang Tuwo** (684): the founding of the Śrīkṣetra park, with a Buddhist vow for all beings.
- **Kota Kapur** (686), **Karang Brahi** and **Palas Pasemah**: the **curse formula** against traitors. Kota Kapur reads (verified, DHARMA text, Griffiths): "... kita savañakta devata mahardhika... maṁrakṣa yaṁ kadatuAn śrīvijaya ... kadāci yaṁ Uraṁdidalaṁñabhūmi ... drohaka ... nivunuḥ ya sumpaḥ" – "you, all the mighty deities who protect the realm of Śrīvijaya ... if anyone in this land is a traitor ... he will be killed by the curse"; the curse extends to his kin (*gotra-santāna*) and names poison, madness and black magic.
- **Telaga Batu / Sebokingking:** the longest. A nāga-hooded stone with a spout, over which water was poured and drunk by officials while the oath was recited.

- *Bible parallels.*
  - **Deut 27:15–26** (the "cursed be he who..." list) and **28:15–68**.
  - **Num 5:11–31** (the water of bitterness that brings the curse into the body), ↔ the Telaga Batu oath-water ritual.
  - Lev 26:14–39; Deut 29:17–20 ("the curse... shall lie upon him").
  - Typological, but formally very close: an oath-curse with water and a list of offences. Like the Neo-Assyrian treaties already translated (Esarhaddon's Succession Treaty), these are royal loyalty oaths. A fine comparative pairing.
- *Soul.* The anxiety of an early maritime state about betrayal, poison and magic.
- *Base text.* **DHARMA** `tfc-nusantara-epigraphy` (GitHub; README badge CC-BY; the files themselves say CC BY-SA 4.0; verified):
  - DHARMA_INSIDENK00050 = Kota Kapur;
  - 00066 = Talang Tuwo;
  - 00139 = Telaga Batu fragment;
  - 00159 = Kedukan Bukit;
  - also Sojomerto, Gandasuli and the Laguna Copper Plate (900 CE, Philippines – the oldest Philippine document).

  122 of the 310 files hold an English translation of more than 20 words (verified count). The Kota Kapur file's translation div seemed empty, so check. Coedès 1930 (BEFEO 30, on Persée, reported) is the classical edition, in French.
- *Feasibility:* good (short; Old Malay is close to Malay and Sanskrit, both well known). *Benefit:* Bible **MED-HIGH** / Soul MEDIUM. *Recommendation:* a small corpus "Śrīvijaya oaths" (5–6 inscriptions, ≈ 100 lines) together with the Old Javanese *sapatha* below.

D2. Old Javanese (9th–15th c.)

- **Inscriptions with *sapatha*** (imprecation) sections: royal land grants (*sīma*), 9th–10th c. The curse invokes the gods and the guardians of the directions against whoever violates the grant: "may he be bitten by a snake, struck by lightning, his head split..." ↔ **Deut 28**. 193 Old Javanese files in DHARMA (verified count). Bible MED-HIGH (formulae) / Soul MEDIUM.
- **Kakawin** (court epics in Indic metres): the **Old Javanese Rāmāyaṇa** (9th c.), Arjunawiwāha (c. 1030), Bhāratayuddha (1157), Sutasoma, Deśawarṇana / Nāgarakṛtāgama (1365).
  - *Base:* Kern 1900 edition of the Rāmāyaṇa (PD, reported). **Robson, *The Old Javanese Rāmāyaṇa: A New English Translation* (ILCAA, Tokyo 2015, 812 pp.)** is an open PDF in the TUFS repository: `hdl.handle.net/10108/125075` → `tufs.repo.nii.ac.jp/record/7669/files/JS2_B197.pdf` (verified: it downloads).
  - Robson's *Arjunawiwāha* (Brill, Bibliotheca Indonesica, 2008) is reported OA via DOAB.
  - Bible LOW / Soul MEDIUM. Indic content is shared with the South Asia survey.
- **Prose:** the Old Javanese *Ādiparwa* (996 CE): the churning of the ocean and **Garuḍa and the nāgas**, the bird–serpent enmity ↔ Gen 1:20–21 typologically. And the ***Tantu Panggĕlaran*** (c. 15th c.): the creation of humans by Brahmā and Wiṣṇu from clay (reported) ↔ Gen 2:7; the gods move Mount Mahameru to Java so that the island stops rocking ↔ Gen 1:9–10. Pigeaud 1924, *De Tantu Panggĕlaran* (Leiden thesis): US-PD; EU © (Pigeaud d. 1988). Bible MEDIUM / Soul MEDIUM.
- *Tools.* **Zoetmulder & Robson, *Old Javanese–English Dictionary*** (KITLV 1982, ©). Free online as SEAlang **OJED**: `http://sealang.net/ojed/` works over **http**; https fails certificate verification (both verified). Zoetmulder, *Kalangwan* (1974), a survey.
- *Feasibility:* medium. Old Javanese is moderately weak for an LLM; Sanskrit loans and the OJED help.

D3. Old Khmer, Cham, Old Mon, Pyu, Old Burmese, Thai, Vietnamese

- **Old Khmer** (from 611 CE, Angkor Borei K.600; about 1,300 inscriptions to the 14th c.). Temple foundations, lists of donated slaves and land, and **imprecations** ("those who destroy this foundation will dwell in the 32 hells as long as sun and moon endure") ↔ Deut 27–28. The **Sdok Kak Thom** inscription (K.235, 1052, Sanskrit + Khmer, ≈ 340 lines) gives a 250-year history of a priestly family and the *devarāja* cult.
  - *Base:* **DHARMA** `tfc-khmer-epigraphy` (CC BY 4.0; **1,353 XML** in `texts/xml`, verified), drawing on the Corpus des inscriptions khmères (Cœdès, *Inscriptions du Cambodge*, 1937–66, French). Tools: Jenner, *A Dictionary of Pre-Angkorian Khmer* and *A Dictionary of Angkorian Khmer* (Pacific Linguistics 2009; reported OA at ANU).
  - Bible MEDIUM (the curse formulae; temple-slave lists ↔ Lev 25:39–46, Lev 27) / Soul MEDIUM (personal names of slaves, a social window).
- **Cham: DHARMA** `tfc-campa-epigraphy` (CC BY 4.0, 125 XML, verified; partly from the Corpus of the Inscriptions of Campā, ISAW).
  - The **Đông Yên Châu** inscription (4th–6th c.?) is often called the oldest text in any Austronesian language: a short text about a sacred well and the king's **nāga** with blessing/curse wording (reported) ↔ Gen 1:21 typologically.
  - Old Cham is very weakly resourced. LOW-MED.
- **Old Mon** (Dvāravatī 6th–8th c.; Pagan 11th c.; Shorto, *A Dictionary of the Mon Inscriptions*, 1971, ©), **Pyu** (5th–9th c.; only partly understood; Griffiths et al.) and **Old Burmese** (the quadrilingual **Myazedi** inscription, 1112/13: Pyu, Mon, Old Burmese, Pali). LOW (short, Buddhist donative). The Myazedi is a curiosity (a "Rosetta stone" for Pyu).
- **Thai:** the **Ram Khamhaeng** inscription (dated 1292). Flag its **authenticity debate**: Piriya Krairiksh and Michael Vickery argued for a 19th-c. composition under King Mongkut, while the majority accepts it. LOW.
- **Vietnamese:** the native origin myths – Lạc Long Quân, the dragon of the sea, and Âu Cơ, the mountain immortal, whose sac of 100 eggs splits into 50 children to the sea and 50 to the mountains – are in the ***Lĩnh Nam chích quái*** (15th c., in Classical Chinese) ↔ Gen 1:20–21 (sea-dragon and mountain/bird lineages) and Gen 10 (division of peoples). Typological. **East Asia agent** (Classical Chinese). Chữ Nôm literature (13th c.+) is late.

E. Australia

General. Aboriginal traditions are the world's oldest continuous oral cultures (occupation is ≥ 50,000–65,000 years). Some narratives plausibly encode events of 7,000–10,000+ years ago: post-glacial sea-level rise around the coast (Nunn & Reid 2016, *Australian Geographer*), and claims linking a Gunditjmara tradition to the Budj Bim eruption, dated c. 37,000 BP (reported, speculative). Almost all text recording in the language dates from 1840–1970 and was done by missionaries (Lutheran: Teichelmann & Schürmann, Meyer, Carl Strehlow, Reuther) or anthropologists (Spencer & Gillen, Berndt, T. G. H. Strehlow).

The ethical constraint (to record in the guidelines). The AIATSIS *Code of Ethics for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Research* (2020) rests on self-determination, Indigenous leadership, impact and value, and accountability. ATSILIRN Protocol 6 says that **secret or sacred material**, including *published* material recorded without an expectation of publication, must not be made available without the community's consent. AIATSIS's own archive does not release identified secret-sacred material. Many published song texts (men's ceremonial verses, *tjurunga* songs) fall into this class. **Rule for this project:** do not translate or publish Aboriginal ceremonial song texts or myths classed as restricted, whatever their copyright status. Public narratives may be considered only with evidence of community authorisation (e.g. community-published bilingual books). aiatsis.gov.au refuses scripted access from this session (403, verified).

E1. Aranda (Arrernte): Carl Strehlow 1907–20; T. G. H. Strehlow 1971

- **Carl Strehlow & M. von Leonhardi, *Die Aranda- und Loritja-Stämme in Zentral-Australien*** (Frankfurt 1907–20, 5 parts). The myths in German (vol. I) and the totemic cult songs in Aranda and Loritja with interlinear German (vols II–III). PD by date (Strehlow d. 1922). Archive.org `bub_gb_IM84AQAAMAAJ` (verified: vol. I, "Mythen, Sagen und Märchen des Aranda-Stammes", and the *altjirangamitjina* "totem-gods").
- Context: **Anna Kenny, *The Aranda's Pepa*** (ANU Press 2013, OA) and ***Carl Strehlow's 1909 Comparative Heritage Dictionary*** (ANU Press 2018, OA). Both are mirrored on archive.org (`oapen-20.500.12657-33507`, `-29448`; verified present).
- **The Altjira debate:** Carl Strehlow claimed a high sky-being *Altjira*. He also used the word for God in his Bible translation, against Spencer & Gillen's denial. This is a contamination issue *inside the scholarship*.
- **T. G. H. Strehlow, *Songs of Central Australia*** (Angus & Robertson 1971, liv + 775 pp.; Arrernte texts with English and a comparison with European verse). © until 2048 (Strehlow d. 1978). It is rare and largely **secret-sacred**. The Strehlow Research Centre (Alice Springs) holds the restricted collection, which is subject to repatriation disputes.
- *Bible parallel:* the ancestors sleeping beneath the ground rise at the beginning and create the landscape ↔ **Gen 1:24** ("let the earth bring forth living creatures"). T. G. H. Strehlow's famous Northern Aranda verse of the Ilbalintja ancestor Karora, who rises from the earth with bandicoots swarming from his body, is a strong typological parallel. *But see the ethics:* **excluded.**
- **Spencer & Gillen** (1899, 1904, 1927; PD). English only, and their methods are flagged: they published restricted ceremonies, Gillen's role as postmaster-informant is uneven, and their evolutionist framework. For history of scholarship only.

E2. Yolŋu (Arnhem Land) song cycles: Djang'kawu, Wawilak, Moon-Bone

- **Djang'kawu (Djanggawul):** two sisters and a brother arrive from the sea, make the waterholes with their digging sticks and give birth to the clans. Berndt, *Djanggawul* (1952; 188 songs in the original with translation; ©).
- **Wawilak sisters:** swallowed by **Yurlunggur (Wititj), the Rainbow Serpent (python)**, who raises a flood and the monsoon. In Warner, *A Black Civilization* (1937, English) and Berndt, *Kunapipi* (1951, ©).
  - ↔ **Gen 1:21** (the great serpent of the waters) and **Gen 6–9** (a flood brought by the serpent because of a ritual pollution, menstrual blood polluting the serpent's well ↔ Lev 15, 18:19).
  - Typological, and very suggestive for the commentary's *tannin* note.
- **The Song of the Moon-Bone** (Wonguri-Mandjigai; Berndt 1948, *Oceania* 19): a public song cycle, famous as poetry; ©.
- **Status:** most of the Wawilak / Kunapipi material is ceremonially restricted. The Moon-Bone song is public but ©. **Not recommended** for translation now; cite only in the apparatus as a typological note.

E3. Other Australian texts (short)

- **Tiwi:** *kulama* yam ceremony songs (Hart & Pilling; C. W. M. Hart; ©).
- **Ngarrindjeri:** the Ngurunderi story (Meyer 1843 vocabulary, Taplin 1879; PD; English).
- **Kaurna:** Teichelmann & Schürmann 1840 (PD; grammar and vocabulary with phrases).
- **Dieri:** Reuther's 13-volume manuscript (1901; translated by Scherer 1974–81; restricted parts).
- **Warlpiri:** community-published dreaming stories – possible future work *with* the community.
- All LOW priority under current constraints.

F. Siberia and the Arctic

F1. Sakha (Yakut) Olonkho

Sakha (Turkic) · tradition at least medieval (the ancestors of the Sakha moved north to the Lena c. 13th–15th c.; the epic shares Turco-Mongol motifs; the date is an estimate) · first records 1840s (Middendorff) and 1880s (Khudyakov in Verkhoyansk); main collections 1880s–1940s. UNESCO Masterpiece 2005.

- *What it is.* Three worlds: the Upper World of the *aiyy* (bright gods: Ürüng Aiyy Toyon), the Middle World of humans, and the Lower World of the *abaasy* (monsters). In the middle stands the world-tree **Aal Luuk Mas**. The hero, sent down from above to clear the Middle World of monsters, fights, marries and makes the land habitable. The opening formula describes the creation of the Middle World (*Orto Doidu*).

- *Bible:* LOW-MED (Gen 1–2's three-tier world; Gen 2:9 the tree; Gen 6:1–4 heroes). *Soul:* HIGH (sung "opera" of the north; *algys* blessings; shamanic cosmology).
- *Base and access.*
  - **Pekarsky (ed.), *Obraztsy narodnoi literatury yakutov*** (1907–18, Sakha texts; PD; Pekarsky d. 1934) and the Khudyakov volumes are **open** in the National Library of Sakha's collection "Тексты олонхо" (192 items: 135 in Sakha, 48 in Russian; the Pekarsky and Khudyakov items are marked "open access"; verified via WebFetch of `nlrs.ru/collections/304`).
  - Modern critical: the **"Памятники фольклора народов Сибири и Дальнего Востока"** series (Novosibirsk, Nauka, 1990–; 35 vols out; vol. 4 *Kyys Debiliye* 1993, vol. 10 *Er Sogotokh* 1996; Sakha + Russian, with notes). Its website `prometeus.nsc.ru/contents/sibfolk/` has the list and tables of contents only (verified). ©.
  - Oyunsky's ***Nyurgun Bootur the Swift*** (1930s; ≈ 36,000 lines; English 2014) is **a literary synthesis by a writer**, like the Kalevala. Prefer the field-recorded olonkhos.
  - Dictionary: Pekarsky, *Slovar' yakutskogo yazyka* (1907–30, PD; reported online).
- *Feasibility:* hard (Sakha is weak for an LLM; Russian facing translation in modern editions; ©). *Recommendation:* a pilot of one olonkho opening (the creation of the Middle World), from Pekarsky (PD) with the Russian of the Novosibirsk volume as a check.

F2. Mansi (Vogul) and Khanty (Ostyak): creation, flood and bear songs

Mansi · tradition ancient (the bear cult may be very old; dualist and earth-diver motifs are shared across northern Eurasia) · recorded by Antal Reguly 1843–44 (the oldest records) and Bernát Munkácsi 1888–89.

- *What it is.*
  - **Munkácsi, *Vogul népköltési gyűjtemény*** (4 vols, 1892–1921, Mansi texts + Hungarian translations): vol. I, "Regék és énekek a világ teremtéséről" ("tales and songs of the creation of the world", verified title page). It holds the earth-diver: Numi-Tōrem, the sky-father, sends a diving bird to bring up earth – "I found no earth" (verified text) – and then the earth grows. Also the **fire-flood** sent to destroy a corrupt humanity.
  - Vols III–IV hold the **bear songs**, sung at the bear feast to send the bear's soul back to its heavenly father.
- *Bible:* MEDIUM – **Gen 1:9** (dry land appears from the water); **Gen 8:6–12** (birds sent to seek land); **Gen 6–9** (flood). Typological; possible Christian or Iranian dualist influence on the earth-diver's adversary figure (debated; Napolskikh's earth-diver catalogue). *Soul:* HIGH (the bear feast is one of the great northern rituals).
- *Base:* **PD, archive.org** (`f1vogulnpklt01munkuoft` etc., verified). Also Kannisto & Liimola (Finnish, mid-20th c.; ©) and Steinitz, *Ostjakische Volksdichtung* (1939–41; ©?) for the Khanty.
- *Feasibility:* very hard. Mansi is barely known to LLMs, so the translation would in practice come from the Hungarian. Munkácsi's orthography is idiosyncratic.

F3. Altai, Buryat, Ket and other South Siberian

- **Radloff, *Proben der Volkslitteratur der türkischen Stämme Süd-Sibiriens*** (1866–1907, 10 parts; texts in Altai, Khakas, Tuvan, Kirghiz etc., with German translations in separate volumes; PD; archive.org, verified present). Vol. I has the Altai creation myth: Ülgen and his rival Erlik, the earth-diver duel. Also Verbitsky (1893) and Anokhin (1924) – the shaman's journey to Ülgen. Bible MEDIUM (Gen 1:9; the adversary ↔ Gen 3, possibly Christian-influenced) / Soul HIGH (shaman's ascent texts).
- **Altai epics** (*Maadai-Kara*, recorded 1973 from A. Kalkin; *Ochi-Bala* in the Novosibirsk series vol. 15; ©).
- **Buryat *Geser*** (oral versions recorded 1890s–1940s: Imegenov, Petrov and others; the 1716 Mongolian woodblock belongs to the **East Asia agent**). Curtin, *A Journey in Southern Siberia* (1909, PD, English only).
- **Ket** (Yenisei): myths of Es and Khosedam (Anuchin 1914; Alekseenko; Russian). LOW for access.
- **Nenets** (Lehtisalo 1947; © to 2032 in Finland). **Evenki** (Novosibirsk vols 1, 32; ©).
- **Nivkh:** Sternberg 1908, *Materials for the study of the Gilyak language and folklore* (PD; reported).

F4. Chukchi, Koryak, Yukaghir, Itelmen (NE Siberia)

Chukchi / Koryak (Chukotko-Kamchatkan) · tradition ancient · recorded in the language 1895–1901 by Waldemar Bogoras and Waldemar Jochelson (both exiled revolutionaries turned ethnographers; Jesup North Pacific Expedition).

- *What it is.* The **Big Raven** (Quikinnaqu) cycle: Raven creates the land and the people, steals the light, and fills the world with a coarse trickster humour (excrement, sex).
- *Bible:* MEDIUM (Gen 1:9–10 and 1:3–5 typologically; Gen 8:7, the raven). *Soul:* MED-HIGH.
- *Base:*
  - **Bogoras, *Koryak Texts*** (Publications of the American Ethnological Society 5, 1917; interlinear Koryak, some Chukchi and Kamchadal, with English; PD; archive.org `koryaktextswald05bogorich`, verified: dialect notes and texts, e.g. "Big-Raven and the Mice").
  - Bogoras, *Chukchee Mythology* (Jesup VIII.1, 1910; PD; reported – AMNH digital library).
  - Jochelson, *The Koryak* (1905–08; English; PD) and *Yukaghir materials* (1900, Russian/Yukaghir).
- *Feasibility:* very hard (the English is the real base).

F5. Inuit (Arctic Canada, Greenland)

Greenlandic / Inuktitut · circumpolar tradition (Thule culture c. 1000–1200 CE onwards; older Dorset/Paleo-Inuit layers are unknown) · recorded from the 1820s; in Greenlandic by Greenlanders themselves for Hinrich Rink in the 1850s.

- *What it is.*
  - The **Sea Woman** (Sedna; Iglulik *Takánakapsâluk*; Greenlandic *Arnaqquassaaq*). Thrown from her father's kayak, she clings to the side, and he chops off her finger-joints. They become the seals, walruses and whales. She lives at the sea bottom and withholds the animals when humans break taboos, until a shaman goes down to comb her hair (Rasmussen 1929, verified: "her father hacked off the top joints of her fingers").
  - Also: Raven and the light, the shaman's flights, the drum songs and "songs of the people" (*aja-ja*), and Uvavnuk's song of the sea that moves her.
- *Bible:* MEDIUM. **Gen 1:21**: the creation of the great sea creatures from a woman's body, versus "And God created the great *tanninim* and every living creature that moves, with which the waters swarmed". Gen 6:5–7 (the animals withdrawn because of human sin); Lev 11–15 (impurity taboos and the animals). *Soul:* HIGH (Rasmussen's informants – Aua, Orpingalik, Uvavnuk – speak directly about fear, joy and song).
- *Base:*
  - **Rink (ed.), *Kaladlit okalluktualliait*** (Godthåb 1859–63, 4 vols; Greenlandic texts by Greenlanders; PD; archive.org `kaladlitokalluk00mlgoog`, verified present). English: Rink, *Tales and Traditions of the Eskimo* (1875, PD).
  - **Rasmussen, *Intellectual Culture of the Iglulik Eskimos*** (Report of the Fifth Thule Expedition 7.1, 1929; English with some Inuktitut song texts; archive.org `intellectualcult00rasm_1`, verified). PD in the EU (Rasmussen d. 1933). In the US, 1929 → PD since 2025.
  - *The Netsilik Eskimos* (1931): US status verify.
  - Thalbitzer, *The Ammassalik Eskimo* (1914–23; East Greenlandic texts with English; PD; archive.org, verified present).
- *Feasibility:* hard. Greenlandic is weak for an LLM (Danish facing; Schultz-Lorentzen's Greenlandic dictionary 1927, PD reported). Rasmussen's Iglulik material is mostly English only.
- **Note:** overlaps with the Americas agent (Inuit of Canada, Alaska).

F6. Ainu (Hokkaido, Sakhalin) – coordinate with the East Asia agent

- **Chiri Yukie, *Ainu shin'yōshū*** (1923): 13 *kamuy yukar* (songs sung by the gods themselves in the first person: the owl-god, the fox, the orca…), Ainu in romanization with Chiri's Japanese. She was a native speaker. PD (Chiri d. 1922; reported, Aozora Bunko).
- **Piłsudski, *Materials for the Study of the Ainu Language and Folklore*** (Cracow 1912; 27 texts with English; PD; reported).
- *Bible:* LOW-MED (animal gods of sea and sky ↔ Gen 1:20–21, typological). *Soul:* **HIGH** (the first line, "Shirokanipe ranran pishkan" – "silver drops fall, fall all around" – is famous).
- *Feasibility:* medium (Ainu is weak, but the Japanese facing translation exists; corpora like the NINJAL Ainu corpus are reported).

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3. Also considered (one line each)

- **Kumuhonua / Nuʻu flood (Hawaiian)**: biblicised 19th-c. "tradition" (Kepelino, Kamakau, Fornander). Use only as a contamination control (A3).
- **Io-matua-kore texts** (*Lore of the Whare-wānanga*, 1913–15; Hare Hongi 1907): very probably post-contact or reworked. Contamination appendix only.
- **Tuamotuan Kiho cult** (Stimson 1933): suspect, like Io. Exclude as independent evidence.
- **Oyunsky's *Nyurgun Bootur*** (1930s): an authorial synthesis, like the Kalevala. Use field-recorded olonkho instead.
- **Rongorongo** (Rapa Nui): undeciphered. Fischer's 1997 "creation chant" reading is not accepted.
- **"Mu" / Lemuria tablets** (Churchward, 1926–): a hoax. The so-called "Naacal tablets" do not exist.
- **Ram Khamhaeng inscription**: authenticity debated (a possible 19th-c. composition). Low priority anyway.
- **Pyu inscriptions**: too poorly understood.
- **Old Mon, Old Burmese** donative inscriptions: short and Buddhist-formulaic. LOW.
- **Spencer & Gillen**: English only, problematic methods, restricted material. History of scholarship only.
- **Berndt, *Djanggawul* and *Kunapipi***: © and largely restricted. Excluded.
- **T. G. H. Strehlow, *Songs of Central Australia***: ©, rare, secret-sacred. Excluded.
- **Darangen, Hinilawod, Ulahingan** (Philippines): modern © recordings, very weak languages. Not now.
- **Ifugao hudhud**: no open base text yet. Revisit if Lambrecht's texts are digitised.
- **Taiwanese Formosan myths** (Ogawa & Asai 1935): © (Japan) and very weak languages. Coordinate with East Asia.
- **Hainuwele** (Seram, Jensen 1939): German only, no native-language text.
- **Tongan myths** (Gifford 1924): mostly English.
- **Grimble, *Tungaru Traditions*** (Kiribati): © (1989).
- **Ngata's *Ngā Mōteatea***: © – but the best key to Grey's 1853 songs. Use privately as a rank-3 source.
- **Malagasy *Tantara ny Andriana***: belongs to the Africa survey.
- **Old Javanese kakawin beyond the Rāmāyaṇa** (Arjunawiwāha, Sutasoma, Deśawarṇana): Indic and courtly. Soul MEDIUM, Bible LOW; Robson's open translations exist.
- **Lĩnh Nam chích quái** (Vietnamese origin myths): Classical Chinese – East Asia agent.
- **Buryat/Mongolian Geser woodblock (1716)**: East Asia agent. The Buryat oral versions are ©, in Russian editions.
- **Hawaiian newspaper corpus**: huge and valuable, but 19th-c. Christian-era prose. A mine for variants, not a single text.

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4. Access notes (tested 2026-10-21 from this session)

Working (HTTP 200 and content seen):

- `archive.org`: advancedsearch API, `/metadata/`, `/download/..._djvu.txt`. Occasional 500 on the first try; a retry works.
- `www.gutenberg.org` (search and `/cache/epub/<id>/pg<id>.txt`).
- `git clone` / `git ls-remote` of `github.com/erc-dharma/*`, and `raw.githubusercontent.com`. But **github.com web pages and api.github.com are 403** for this session.
- `oxis.org` (the La Galigo PDFs).
- `tufs.repo.nii.ac.jp` → Oracle object storage (Robson's Rāmāyaṇa).
- `http://sealang.net/ojed/` (http only).
- `www.ulukau.org` (home page only).
- `maoridictionary.co.nz` (root).
- `nlrs.ru` (via WebFetch).
- `www.prometeus.nsc.ru`.
- `www.paradisec.org.au` (home).
- `digitalcollections.universiteitleiden.nl` (returns 200, but the content is a bot wall, see below).
- `core.ac.uk`, `www.persee.fr`, `journals.openedition.org`, `brill.com`, `www.jstor.org`, `openresearch-repository.anu.edu.au`, `press-files.anu.edu.au`, `scholarspace.manoa.hawaii.edu`, `evols.library.manoa.hawaii.edu`, `trove.nla.gov.au`, `folklore.ru`, `www.ruthenia.ru`, `feb-web.ru`, `www.kunstkamera.ru`, `www.digitale-sammlungen.de`, `polona.pl`, `www.e-rara.ch`, `kalliope-verbund.info`, `dharma.hypotheses.org`, `erc-dharma.github.io`.

Blocked or failing:

- `nzetc.victoria.ac.nz` → 301 to `ndhadeliver.natlib.govt.nz/webarchive/20210104000423/...` → **Incapsula block** (all NZETC texts unreachable).
- `paperspast.natlib.govt.nz`: Incapsula (so the JPS archive is unreachable).
- `www.jps.auckland.ac.nz`: SSL_ERROR_SYSCALL.
- `www.thepolynesiansociety.org`: 503.
- `puke.ulukau.org`, `www.wehewehe.org` (Pukui–Elbert), `sacred-texts.com`: **Cloudflare challenge** (403). WebFetch is also 403.
- `digitalcollections.universiteitleiden.nl/LaGaligo`: F5 bot wall ("Toegang geblokkeerd").
- `library.oapen.org` bitstreams and REST: Anubis anti-bot / "address not allowed". **Use the archive.org `oapen-...` mirrors.**
- `www.doabooks.org` 403; `babel.hathitrust.org` 403; `gallica.bnf.fr` 403; `www.biodiversitylibrary.org` 403; `www.delpher.nl` 503.
- `aiatsis.gov.au` 403; `www.elararchive.org` 403; `catalog.paradisec.org.au` 403.
- `cii.efeo.fr`, `khmer-studies.org`, `dlib.indonesia.ac.id`, `sakhaepos.ru`, `www.iea.ras.ru`, `ilcrs.ru`, `avakonohi.com`, `www.press.anu.edu.au`, `www.pacificlinguistics.org`, `dspace.nlrs.ru`: proxy CONNECT 502 (policy denial or upstream failure).
- `www.efeo.fr` and `https://sealang.net`: certificate verification failure.
- `sastra.org`, `www.nzetc.org`, `web.archive.org`, `igi.ysn.ru`: connection reset.
- `olonkho.info`: TLS handshake failure.
- `exhibits.stanford.edu/copyrightrenewals`: bot-protected (the Beckwith renewal could not be checked).

For a future session's allowlist / unblocking: ulukau.org sub-sites (puke, wehewehe, nupepa), sacred-texts.com, papers past and jps.auckland.ac.nz, the NDHA web archive (NZETC), Leiden digital collections, library.oapen.org, aiatsis.gov.au, catalog.paradisec.org.au, cii.efeo.fr, igi.ysn.ru, web.archive.org, github.com (web/API).

Downloads cached (untrusted; nothing executed) under `/tmp/claude-0/-home-user-perush/009325a3-391a-55eb-9c0e-32e1e254e6c6/scratchpad/world/pacific-australia-siberia/`:

- `kumulipo.txt` (Stampe interlinear OCR);
- `grey1854.txt`;
- `dl_galigo/v1.pdf`;
- `dl_scharer/t.txt`;
- `ia/*.txt` (Fornander 1878, Gill, White I, Koryak Texts, Rink, Rasmussen 1929, Munkácsi I, Radloff, C. Strehlow I, Argonauts);
- `forn1.txt`, `emerson.txt`;
- `git/` (DHARMA blobless clones; Nusantara `xml/` checked out).

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5. Sources consulted

- Brief and project files: `translation-guidelines.md` §1, §2.3, §3, §8; `curated-translation-candidates.md`; `curation-surveys/relevance-survey--2026-10-16.md`, `availability-survey--2026-10-16.md`.

- Kumulipo:
  - https://archive.org/details/kumulipo-hawaiian-english (Stampe interlinear, verified);
  - https://archive.org/details/kumulipo-beckwith (user upload of Beckwith, not used);
  - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kumulipo;
  - https://sacred-texts.com/pac/ku/ (blocked; the "not renewed" claim via search result);
  - https://www.bonhams.com/auction/28447/lot/40/ (1889 edition);
  - Bastian 1881: https://archive.org/details/dieheiligesagede00bastuoft.
- Fornander: https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/72686, /73166, /74570; *Account of the Polynesian Race* https://archive.org/details/bub_gb_tcQNAAAAQAAJ.
- Emerson: https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/20299. Malo: https://archive.org/details/hawaiianantiquit00malorich.
- Māori:
  - https://archive.org/details/kongamahingaang00greygoog;
  - https://archive.org/details/kongamoteateame00greygoog;
  - https://archive.org/details/ancienthistoryof01whit;
  - https://archive.org/details/polynesianmythol00greyuoft;
  - Shortland https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/42218;
  - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/New_Zealand_Electronic_Text_Collection.
- Gill: https://archive.org/details/mythssongsfromso00gill. Krämer: https://archive.org/details/bub_gb_m0o1AQAAMAAJ.
- I La Galigo:
  - https://oxis.org/resources-3/la-galigo/01-la-galigo-i.pdf, /02-la-galigo-ii.pdf;
  - https://oxis.org/m-z/macknight-campbell/macknight-2018.pdf;
  - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/La_Galigo;
  - https://digitalcollections.universiteitleiden.nl/LaGaligo (blocked).
- Schärer:
  - https://library.oapen.org/handle/20.500.12657/32191 (blocked);
  - https://directory.doabooks.org/handle/20.500.12854/29139;
  - https://archive.org/details/oapen-20.500.12657-32191;
  - *Ngaju Religion*: https://link.springer.com/book/9789401185790.
- DHARMA:
  - https://github.com/erc-dharma/tfc-nusantara-epigraphy;
  - https://github.com/erc-dharma/tfc-khmer-epigraphy;
  - https://github.com/erc-dharma/tfc-campa-epigraphy;
  - https://dharma.hypotheses.org/.
- Old Javanese: http://sealang.net/ojed/; https://hdl.handle.net/10108/125075 (Robson 2015); https://oalib-perpustakaan.upi.edu/Record/doab_20_500_12854_37484 (Arjunawiwāha).
- Philippines:
  - https://sil-philippines-languages.org/ical/papers/stanyukovich-hudhud.pdf;
  - https://www.ortigasfoundationlibrary.com.ph/collections/library-holdings/hudhud-dinulawan-and-bugan-gonhadan;
  - https://ehrafworldcultures.yale.edu/cultures/oa19/documents/020 (Barton 1955);
  - https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/40807, /46024.
- Australia:
  - https://archive.org/details/bub_gb_lM84AQAAMAAJ (C. Strehlow);
  - https://archive.org/details/oapen-20.500.12657-33507;
  - https://archive.org/details/oapen-20.500.12657-29448;
  - https://equinoxpub.com/home/view-chapter/?id=27447 (Cox on Strehlow);
  - https://digital.library.adelaide.edu.au/items/7d2d147c-8f98-4843-be09-28c54bc7bbcd;
  - https://www.nsla.org.au/resources/cslp-collections/protocol6/ (ATSILIRN Protocol 6);
  - https://www.wipo.int/documents/d/traditional-knowledge/creative-heritage-en-aiatsis_policy_ethics.pdf.
- Siberia:
  - https://nlrs.ru/collections/304;
  - https://www.prometeus.nsc.ru/contents/sibfolk/;
  - https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Olonkho;
  - https://www.cambridge.org/core/books/olonkho/foreword/86499FB22D761D09671C0C63714BFDD9;
  - Munkácsi https://archive.org/details/f1vogulnpklt01munkuoft;
  - Radloff https://archive.org/details/probendervolksl05radlgoog;
  - Bogoras https://archive.org/details/koryaktextswald05bogorich.

- Arctic:
  - https://archive.org/details/kaladlitokalluk00mlgoog;
  - https://archive.org/details/intellectualcult00rasm_1;
  - https://archive.org/details/ammassalikeskimo02thaluoft;
  - https://archive.org/details/netsilikeskimoss00rasm.
- Malinowski: https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/55822; https://archive.org/details/argonautsofweste1922mali.